Zenopher: Start Page Specification

Status: Draft v1, decisions locked **Scope:** The first screen after launch and the place the user returns to. Covers the sidebar, the home section, empty and first-time states, and behavior.

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1. Purpose

The start page is where every session begins. It gives the user three things: a way to create or open a design, quick access to recent and saved work, and access to app-level settings and information. It stays out of the editor's way once a design is open.

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2. Layout

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3. The sidebar

The sidebar holds app-level destinations. It stays visible on every start-page screen. The user can collapse it to icons, and the collapsed state is remembered.

The sidebar items are the only place these destinations appear. The rest of the app does not carry its own copies, so each destination has exactly one home.

3.1 Main

Item	Purpose	v1
Home	This screen.	Yes
Designs	All saved designs, with folders and sorting.	Yes
Templates	Presets and developer-made templates.	Presets only in v1; full templates later
Shared	Designs shared with others.	No, appears only when collaboration exists
Trash	Deleted designs, kept for 30 days before permanent removal.	Yes

3.2 Learn

Item	Purpose	v1
Tutorials	Short guides on how the teacher's patterns work.	Yes
Style library	Browse every style profile and its example designs.	Yes

3.3 Account

Item	Purpose	v1
Profile	Name and avatar, stored locally on the device.	Yes. Email appears only with sign-in.
Settings	Appearance, default mode, default style, autosave interval, and units.	Yes. Language is not included in v1.
Privacy	AI review consent, the learning-data toggle, and export or deletion of that data.	Yes
Help	Documentation, keyboard shortcuts, and contact.	Yes
Legal	Terms of service, privacy policy, and open-source notices.	Yes
Sign in	Account sign-in.	Shown as "Sign in (coming later)"

Settings and Privacy are separate items on purpose. The consent controls must be easy to find and change, and they should not be buried inside general settings.

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4. The home section

4.1 Greeting and search

- A short greeting that uses the local profile name. If no name is set, it reads "Good morning" without a name.
- A search field that covers designs, templates, and styles. Results are grouped by type.

4.2 Create

- **New design:** starts the flow in the workflow document (size, then mode, then style, then editor).
- **Open file:** opens a `.zph`, PNG, or PSD file.

4.3 Recent designs

- The last designs the user opened, shown as thumbnails with a name and the date.
- Each card shows the style used, so the user can see what the design was checked against.
- Recent designs are tracked automatically.
- A menu on each card (right-click or an overflow button) offers: open, rename, duplicate, and delete.
- "See all" opens the Designs page.
- If there are no recent designs, this section is hidden entirely. It is not shown empty.

4.4 Start from a preset

- Developer-made canvas presets: Instagram post, A4, business card, presentation slide, and custom.
- Each preset starts a new design at that size. Style and mode are left for the user to choose in the flow.
- "See all" opens the Templates page.

4.5 Saved designs

- Designs the user has saved with an explicit name.
- Kept separate from recent designs, which are tracked automatically.
- "See all" opens the Designs page.

4.6 No designs yet

If the user has no designs, the home section shows the presets and a short prompt in place of the empty rows.

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5. Empty and first-time states

State	What the user sees
First launch	The greeting becomes a short introduction. Presets appear first. A "Take a quick tour" option points to Learn > Tutorials.
No recent designs	The Recent designs section is hidden.
No saved designs	The Saved designs section is hidden.
Offline	Designs open and save normally. AI review and remote style-library examples are unavailable, and the page says so in plain words.

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6. Behavior

- **Opening a design** restores it at its last saved state, with its mode and style. The teacher stays quiet until the user acts.
- **Deleting** moves the design to Trash. It is permanently removed after 30 days, or when the user empties Trash.
- **Duplicating** keeps the style but not the teacher's history. The copy starts with a clean history.
- **Settings** apply to new designs only. A design that already has its own mode or style keeps it.
- **Autosave** writes to browser storage (IndexedDB). Designs are available offline.

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7. Storage

- Designs autosave to IndexedDB on the device, so they work offline.
- Clearing browser data deletes them. The app shows a reminder to export important designs as `.zph` files, and offers an export action on each design card.
- Cloud sync is not part of v1. It will be considered once real users show a need for it.

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8. Accounts (v1 decision)

- **v1 runs locally.** There is no sign-in. The profile (name and avatar) is stored on the device.
- The Account section still exists, so the layout is ready for sign-in. "Sign in" shows as "Sign in (coming later)".
- Adding sign-in later does not change the structure of the sidebar or the home section.

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9. Trash

- Deleted designs move to Trash.
- Each item shows how many days remain before permanent removal (30 days by default).
- A user can restore an item from Trash, or delete it permanently at any time.
- "Empty Trash" removes all items permanently after a confirmation prompt.

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10. Language (v1 decision)

- **English only in v1.**
- All interface text is kept in a single string file from the start, so translations can be added later without changing components.
- The Language setting is not shown in v1.

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11. Legal and open-source notices

The Legal page includes:

- Terms of service
- Privacy policy
- Open-source notices, including the **PhotoCraft MIT and Apache-2.0 notices**, since the engine is based on that project

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12. Decisions locked in

Decision	Choice	Why
Accounts	Local first, no sign-in in v1	Keeps the first build small. The Account section is laid out for sign-in later.
Storage	IndexedDB autosave plus `.zph` export	Works offline. Export protects users from losing work when browser data is cleared.
Trash retention	30 days	Long enough to recover from mistakes, short enough to keep storage in check.
Language	English only	One string file keeps translation possible later without rework.

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13. Open items after v1

- Sign-in and account recovery.
- Cloud sync and sharing (the "Shared" item).

- Full template library beyond presets.
- Language selection and translations.
- Folders for designs, if the Designs page needs more than sorting.

New Design Flow

This section covers the pages that follow the start page once the user has chosen a size. It starts with the **Set up your design** page, then opens the editor.

Assumption: the page after the canvas choice combines mode and style on one screen, since both are short choices made before editing. If you want them as two separate pages, the split is noted in Section 3.

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1. Flow overview

Every route into the editor passes through **Set up design**. The user can skip the choices on that page, but cannot skip the page itself, so the mode and style are always set deliberately or left at their defaults.

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2. Choose size (reference)

The size page is defined in the workflow document. This spec starts after it.

- Input: a preset (Instagram post, A4, business card, presentation slide) or custom width, height, and unit.
- Output: a page size. Unit conversions use the rules already set for artboards.
- If the user came from a preset card on the start page, this step is skipped.

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3. Set up design

3.1 Purpose

Choose how the teacher behaves (mode) and which design style it measures against (style). Both are editable later, so the page makes choices easy rather than final.

3.2 Layout

3.3 Mode selection

- Two options, **Creative** and **Corporate**. One must be selected before the design can be created.
- The default is the value in Settings > Default mode. If the user has not changed it, the default is **Creative**, since it is the quieter mode for first use.
- Each option shows one line on what it does, written in plain words.
- The choice is saved with the design and can be changed in the editor at any time.

3.4 Style selection

- **Optional.** The user can leave it empty.
- **Browse** opens the style library in a picker, with the same cards and examples as the Learn > Style library page.
- A chosen style shows its thumbnail, name, and a one-line summary of its main color and layout pattern.
- The default is the value in Settings > Default style. If none is set, the field is empty.
- If the style field is empty, the teacher stays off. The page says so directly under the field.

- The choice is saved with the design and can be changed in the editor at any time.

3.5 Actions

Button	Result
Create design	Saves the size, mode, and style (if chosen) as a new design, then opens the editor. Enabled once a mode is selected.
Skip for now	Creates the design with the default mode and no style, then opens the editor.
← Back	Returns to the size step. Nothing is created.
Change (size)	Returns to the size step with the current size preselected.

"Skip for now" and "Create design" both create the design. The only difference is which values are used. This keeps the path to the editor the same for every user.

3.6 Validation

- **Mode:** required. "Create design" stays disabled until one is selected, or the default from Settings is already set.
- **Style:** not required. No warning is shown for leaving it empty.
- **Size:** inherited from the previous step. This page never shows a size error.

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4. Opening the editor

When the design is created:

1. The design is saved to IndexedDB immediately, so it appears in Recent designs even if the user closes the tab before editing.
2. The editor opens with the chosen size on the artboard.
3. The mode is applied:
    - **Creative:** the agent icon is replaced by "Check my design", and no findings are shown.
    - **Corporate:** the agent icon is shown, and the teacher runs after the first change.
4. If a style is set, the teacher uses it. If not, the agent icon shows "Choose a style" and the teacher stays off.
5. The editor opens with the first page empty and the Properties panel closed. Nothing is selected.

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5. Changing choices after creation

- **Mode** can be changed from the top bar in the editor. The change applies immediately and is undoable.
- **Style** can be changed from the style chip in the editor, or from Design settings. The teacher re-runs against the new style. The change is undoable.
- **Size** is changed through Resize in the editor, not from this page.

Changing mode or style never changes the design content.

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6. Edge cases

Case	Behavior
User presses Back after choosing a mode and style	Choices are kept in memory and shown again if the user returns to this page in the same session.
User closes the page without creating	Nothing is saved. The size choice is discarded.
Browser closes during the page	Nothing is saved. The user starts again from the start page.
Style library fails to load (offline)	The Browse button shows "Styles unavailable offline". Skip and Create design still work.
Chosen style is removed from the library later	The design keeps the style ID. The teacher shows "Style no longer available" and stays off until the user picks another.

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7. Keyboard and accessibility

- Tab order: size summary, Change, mode options, style field, Browse, Skip for now, Create design.
- Mode options are a radio group. Arrow keys move between them.
- The style field announces its state. An empty style reads "No style selected".
- Each mode option has a visible label, not only an icon or color.
- Enter on the page activates Create design when it is enabled.

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8. Decisions recorded

Decision	Choice	Why
Mode and style on one page	Yes	Both are short choices made before editing, so one page avoids an extra click.
Default mode	Creative, unless changed in Settings	Quieter for first use. Users who want the teacher can switch in one click.
Style required	No, optional	Lets users start designing immediately. The teacher waits instead of guessing.
Skip path	Creates the design with defaults	Keeps the editor entry point the same for every route.

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9. Open items

- Whether Creative and Corporate should show a short example of what the teacher does, on this page or in a tooltip.
- Whether the style summary should show its main color or layout pattern, which depends on how the style profiles are written.
- Whether this page should split into two screens if the style library grows large enough to need more room.

Creation Flow and Editor Modes

This section defines the path from the home page to the editor, and how the three editor levels behave. It replaces the earlier "Set up your design" draft in this file, which is superseded by the flow below.

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1. The flow

Routes:

- **Home → New design → Size → Continue → Mode**
- **Creative → Editor.** Style is not asked for.
- **Corporate → Style (skip allowed) → Editor.**

Preset cards on the home page follow the same route, starting at the size step with the size already chosen. They do not skip the mode step.

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2. Screens

2.1 Choose size

- Shows presets (Instagram post, A4 document, business card, presentation slide) and Custom.
- Each preset shows its name and dimensions.
- Custom opens width, height, and unit fields.
- **Continue** is the primary button. It is enabled once a size is selected.
- **Back** returns to the home page. Nothing is created.

2.2 Choose mode

- Two options: **Creative** and **Corporate**.
- Each option has a one-line plain description:
  - Creative: "Design freely. No help or checks."
  - Corporate: "Checks your design as you work and explains what to fix."
- Default: the Settings default mode, or Creative if none is set.

- **Continue** goes to Style for Corporate, or straight to the editor for Creative.
- **Back** returns to the size step.

2.3 Choose style (Corporate only)

- Shows the style library as cards, each with an example and its name.
- A **Skip** button sits next to the **Choose** action. Skipping is allowed.
- Skip goes to the editor with no style attached.
- Choose goes to the editor with the selected style attached.
- Each card shows a one-line summary of the style.
- **Back** returns to the mode step.

Skip is a normal, supported path. The page does not warn the user for choosing it.

2.4 Editor

- Opens with an empty page at the chosen size.
- The top bar shows the current mode, and the style chip if a style is attached.
- The mode, and any attached style, are saved with the design.

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3. Editor levels

The editor has three levels. Each level builds on the one below it.

3.1 Creative

- **Monitoring:** none.
- **Help:** none. No suggestions, no hints, no prompts.
- **Findings:** none. The teacher does not run.
- **Check button:** none. "Check my design" is not offered.
- **Style:** can be attached, but has no effect in this level.
- **Purpose:** a pure design tool.

3.2 Corporate, no style

- **Monitoring:** base checks run after changes.
- **Base checks:** contrast, text size, alignment, crop, and spacing or margin.
- **Findings:** yes or no results for each base check. Each result states the measured value and the required value.
- **Fixes:** available for base findings only.
- **Apply all:** applies base fixes only. The summary says so.
- **Style prompt:** a "Choose style" option is available in the teacher panel. It is not required.

3.3 Corporate, with style

- **Monitoring:** base checks and all style checks run after changes.
- **Teacher features:** full set, including:
  - confidence levels: must change, and optional
  - suggested corrections
  - the explanation for each finding (the ⓘ button)
  - the AI critique, if the user has opted in
- **Fixes:** available for every finding.
- **Apply all:** applies high-confidence fixes, base and style. The summary lists them.

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4. Changes between levels

Change	What happens
Creative → Corporate	The teacher turns on. The canvas does not change. Base checks run.
Corporate → Creative	The teacher turns off. Findings disappear. The canvas does not change.
Corporate, no style → add a style	Style checks are added to the panel. Base findings stay the same. No note is shown.
Corporate, with style → remove the style	Style findings disappear. Base findings stay the same.
Creative → add a style	The style is attached and saved. Nothing is shown, since Creative has no findings.

A design can move between levels any number of times. Each change is a view change, except style changes, which are document changes.

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5. Undo and history

Action	In undo history
Switching modes	No
Attaching or removing a style	Yes
Applying a single fix	Yes
Apply all	Yes, as one step
Changing the canvas	Yes

Mode is a view setting. The style is part of the design, because it changes what the teacher measures.

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6. Saving and reopening

- The mode is saved with the design.
- The style, if attached, is saved with the design, even when the design is in Creative. It is inactive until the user switches to Corporate.
- Reopening a design restores its mode and style.
- Reopening does not run the teacher until the user makes a change, or switches into a Corporate level. Opening a file is quiet.

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7. Do's and don'ts

Do

- Keep the Creative editor free of teacher elements. No badges, no icons, no hints.
- Keep Skip as a normal, equal-weight option on the style step.
- Show the measured value and the required value for every base finding, so the user can see what the check measured.
- Make it clear which level the user is in, using the mode label in the top bar.
- Keep "Apply all" clearly labeled with what it will change before it runs.
- Save the style with the design even when the design is in Creative.

Don't

- Don't show any finding in Creative, including a count, a badge, or a pulse.
- Don't block the editor when the style is skipped.
- Don't warn the user about skipping the style. It is a normal choice.
- Don't include style findings in "Apply all" when no style is attached.
- Don't add mode switching to the undo history.

- Don't change the canvas when switching modes.
- Don't run the teacher just because a file was opened.

8. Edge cases

Case	Behavior
Style attached in Creative, then user switches to Corporate	Full Corporate level with that style, since it's already attached.
Style chosen in Corporate, then removed, then Corporate kept	Base checks only, with the "Choose style" option available.
Attached style removed from the library	The design keeps the style ID. Style checks are off, and the panel shows "Style no longer available" with a Choose style option.
Apply all in no-style Corporate, with no base fixes available	The button is disabled, with a message that no base fixes are available.
Offline, AI critique requested	Critique is unavailable, and the panel says so. Rules still run.

9. Accessibility

- Mode and style are shown as text labels, not only icons or colors.
- Each level's findings are announced when they change, without interrupting typing.
- The Skip and Choose buttons on the style step are keyboard reachable in a logical order.
- The mode options are a radio group, so arrow keys move between them.

10. Decisions recorded

Decision	Choice
Creative findings	None. No "Check my design" button.
Style in Corporate	Optional, with a Skip option that is a normal path.
Base checks	Contrast, text size, alignment, crop, spacing or margin. Run in Corporate with or without a style.
Fixes in no-style Corporate	Base findings only.
Mode switching	View change only, not in undo history.
Style changes	Document change, in undo history.
Style in Creative	Can be attached and saved. Inactive while in Creative.